

Word family: **coast / coasts / coastal / coastline**

Base word: coast

Plural: coasts

Related forms: coastal, coastline

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “We joined a short snorkeling tour near the **coast**...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **coast** means the **land beside the sea, especially the area where the land meets the sea**.

繁體中文： **陸地與海洋相接的地帶；海岸 / 沿海地區**

中文翻譯：

> “...a short snorkeling tour near the **coast**...”

「.....參加了一個靠近**海岸 / 沿岸**的短途浮潛行程.....」

Here:

near the coast = 靠近海岸線 / 沿海地區

1. **coast = land beside the sea (地理) — 海岸；沿海地區**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: The land along the edge of the sea.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We joined a snorkeling tour near the **coast**.”

「我們參加了一個靠近**海岸**的浮潛行程。」

Practice 2

> “They drove along the **coast**.”

「他們沿着**海岸**駕車。」

Practice 3

> “Many small towns lie on the west **coast**.”

「西**海岸**有很多小鎮。」

****coast = 陸地與海洋相接的一帶，尤其指沿海區域****

Common:

- * east coast
- * west coast
- * along the coast
- * near the coast
- * coastal town

2. ****coast = shoreline / boundary where land meets sea (界線) — 海岸線****

Sometimes ****coast**** focuses more specifically on the boundary or edge between land and sea.

Practice 4

> “The storm damaged villages along the ****coast****.”

「暴風破壞了沿****海岸線****的村落。」

Practice 5

> “The ****coast**** is rocky in this area.”

「這一帶的****海岸線****多岩石。」

****coast = 海陸相接的邊界或沿線地帶****

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1. It is the same geographic concept with a slightly narrower focus.

3. ****coast = move without using power / with little effort (動詞) — 滑行；靠慣性前進****

As a verb, ****coast**** means to move easily without using much power, often because momentum,

gravity, or a slope carries you.

Practice 6

> “The bicycle **coasted** downhill.”

「單車靠慣性滑下坡。」

Practice 7

> “The car **coasted** to a stop.”

「汽車靠慣性滑行至停下。」

coast = 不再主動加速，而利用慣性、重力或已有速度輕鬆向前移動

This is a genuinely distinct verb meaning.

4. **coast** = succeed/progress with little effort (比喻) — 輕鬆過關；不太用力便前進

Coast can figuratively mean continuing successfully without much effort.

Practice 8

> “She **coasted** through the exam.”

「她幾乎沒怎麼費力就輕鬆通過了考試。」

Practice 9

> “The team **coasted** to an easy victory.”

「那支隊伍輕鬆取得勝利。」

coast = 幾乎不需要太多努力便順利完成、通過或取得成功

This is a figurative extension of the physical “move easily without power” sense.

For core counting, I would merge it with Meaning 3.

5. **coast** = stop making much effort because things seem easy (比喻) — 鬆懈；靠老本

Another figurative use emphasizes ****not trying very hard**** because success seems secure.

Practice 10

> “He started to ****coast**** after getting good early results.”

「他早期取得好成績後便開始****鬆懈 / 靠老本****。」

Practice 11

> “You can’t just ****coast**** through the rest of the course.”

「你不能在剩下的課程中一直****不太努力、混過去****。」

****coast** = 因覺得事情容易或已有優勢，而減少努力、只是順勢前進******

This is related to Meaning 4 but adds a mildly negative nuance.

Related form: ****coastal****

****Coastal**** means relating to or located near the coast.

Practice 12

> “They visited several ****coastal**** villages.”

「他們參觀了幾個****沿海****村落。」

Practice 13

> “The area has a mild ****coastal**** climate.”

「這個地區有溫和的****沿海****氣候。」

****coastal** = 位於海岸附近或與海岸有關的******

Related form: ****coastline****

****Coastline**** means the outline or length of land where it meets the sea.

Practice 14

> “The island has a long rocky **coastline**.”

「這個島有一條很長的岩石**海岸線**。」

Practice 15

> “The **coastline** has changed over time.”

「**海岸線**隨時間有所改變。」

coastline = 陸地與海洋相接所形成的線形邊界

This is closely related to the noun **coast**, but more specifically refers to the line/outline itself.

Important distinction: **coast vs beach**

coast

= the broad land area along the sea.

beach

= a specific stretch of sand, pebbles, etc. beside the sea.

A coast may contain:

- * beaches
- * cliffs
- * rocks
- * ports

So:

coast = 海岸 / 沿海地區

beach = 海灘

Important distinction: **coast vs shore**

shore

is the land directly beside a body of water.

coast

normally refers specifically to land beside the sea/ocean and often to a larger geographic region.

> lake shore

> sea coast

So **shore** is broader in water-body type, while **coast** is more specifically marine.

Important distinction: **coast vs coastline**

coast

= the coastal land/region

coastline

= the exact boundary line or outline where land meets sea

> “They live on the coast.”

natural.

> “They live on the coastline.”

possible but more geographic/technical.

Important distinction: **coast vs glide**

coast

as a verb means move using momentum/gravity with little active power.

glide

means move smoothly and continuously.

A vehicle can:

> coast downhill

because it is not using much power.

A bird can:

> glide through the air

because the focus is smooth motion.

There is overlap, but the emphasis differs.

Important distinction: **coast vs drift**

coast

suggests continued movement from existing momentum, often in a fairly controlled direction.

drift

suggests movement caused by wind/current or lack of control.

> coast to a stop

> drift out to sea

Different motion image.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **coast**

* **coasts**

* **coastal**

* **coastline**

Useful constructions include:

* near the coast

* along the coast

* east/west coast

* coastal area

* coastline

* coast downhill

- * coast to a stop
- * coast through something

The Golden Manual says common figurative verb uses and family forms should be included, while close contextual variants should be merged where the same underlying idea still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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coast — geographic land	陸地與海洋相接的一帶；海岸 / 沿海地區
coast — shoreline focus	海陸相接的邊界或沿線地帶；與 geographic-coast 義相同
coast — verb, physical movement	利用慣性、重力或已有速度，在幾乎不主動用力的情況下前進
coast — figurative progress	幾乎不需太多努力便順利完成、通過或前進
coast — figurative slackening	因事情容易或已有優勢而不再太努力、只是順勢前進
coastal	位於海岸附近或與海岸有關的
coastline	陸地與海洋相接形成的線形邊界；海岸線

For your original sentence

> “...a short snorkeling tour near the ****coast****...”

The exact meaning is:

****coast = 陸地與海洋相接的沿海地帶****

So:

> ****near the coast****

= ****靠近海岸 / 近岸****

In this passage, it helps establish that the snorkeling activity happened close to land rather than far out at sea.

For your database, I would count ****2 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****coast****:

1. ****noun — the land/region along the sea****
2. ****verb — move with little active effort, physically or figuratively****

I would merge ****shoreline/coastal-region**** variations under #1, and merge ****coast downhill / coast through an exam / coast because success feels easy**** under #2 as literal and figurative extensions.